

Find Opportunities

Requirements

Goal

Find every topic worth covering, and decide whether to write a new page or improve a page we already have.

What the engine looks at

The engine reviews each of the following, in order.

1. Keyword research

What people are searching for, and how often.

Data source: **DataForSEO**

2. Competitor gaps

Topics competitors rank for that we don't cover at all.

Data source: **DataForSEO**

3. Competitor top pages

The pages driving their best traffic — proof of what works in our market.

Data source: **DataForSEO**

4. Search Console performance

What we currently rank for across all our pages.

Data source: **Google Search Console**

5. Sitemap and existing pages

Everything we've already published, so we don't repeat ourselves.

Data source: **Site sitemap**

6. Ranking decay

Keywords that used to sit in the top 3–5 and have since dropped out. The page already has authority — it's losing ground, not starting from zero.

Data source: **Google Search Console**

7. Quick wins

Keywords sitting in positions 7–20. Close enough to page one that small improvements can move them.

Data source: **Google Search Console**

8. What's working in other markets

A topic proven in one market is a strong candidate for the others.

9. Conversion performance

Which existing categories actually convert, so topics in proven areas are weighted higher than ones that only look good on search volume.

Data source: **GA4**

Three sources in total. DataForSEO gives the outside view of the market. Search Console gives the inside view of our own pages. GA4 tells us which of it is worth anything commercially.

What the engine produces

A single Google Sheet. One row per topic.

P0 columns must be filled for every row. P1 columns are added where the data is available.

#	Column	Priority	What goes in it
1	Topic	P0	The subject of the page, in plain language.
2	Market	P0	Which market and language this row belongs to (UK, DE, FR, NL).
3	Category	P1	Which part of the site it belongs to.
4	Primary keyword	P0	Main keyword, with monthly search volume in brackets.
5	Secondary keywords	P0	Supporting keywords, each with volume in brackets.
6	Total search volume	P0	Combined monthly searches across all keywords for the topic.
7	Current position	P0	Where we rank today. A dash if the page does not exist yet.
8	Previous position	P1	Where it ranked before. Used for decay rows.
9	Action	P0	New content, Optimise existing, Merge or Ignore.
10	Target URL	P0	The existing page to improve or merge. Blank for new content.
11	Why flagged	P1	Which signal surfaced this opportunity. One of the nine checks above.
12	Difficulty	P1	How hard it will be to rank against current competition.
13	Page type	P1	Guide, review, explainer, list, tool or comparison.
14	Suggested slug	P1	Proposed URL for new pages.
15	Conversion potential	P1	High, Medium or Low, based on GA4 data from similar pages.
16	Competitor URL	P1	The page currently winning this topic.
17	AI search opportunity	P1	Yes or No — can we realistically be cited in AI answers.
18	Estimated impact	P1	Left empty for now.
19	Priority score	P1	Where this sits in the queue. Higher scores are worked first.

Settings

These thresholds must be adjustable per client.

- **Quick win band**
Currently positions 7–20.
- **Decay trigger**
Currently a drop out of the top 3–5.
- **Markets in scope**
Currently UK, DE, FR and NL.

Rules

- **Check before creating**
Every topic is checked against existing pages before a new page is proposed. This prevents duplication and keyword cannibalisation.

- **One row per topic**
Not one row per keyword. Related keywords are grouped under the topic they belong to.
- **Every row is actionable**
A row is only added to the sheet if it carries an action: create, optimise, merge or ignore.
- **Scored, not just collected**
Opportunities are prioritised, so the highest-value work rises to the top of the queue.

Dependencies

- **GA4 connection**
Required for the conversion performance check and the conversion potential column. Until GA4 is connected the engine runs without a commercial signal, and conversion potential is a judgement call rather than data.
- **Search Console access**
Required for four of the nine checks. Without it the engine can only see the outside view.

Open items

- **Estimated impact**
Column left blank until the method for calculating it is agreed.
- **Priority score**
Currently P1, but the rules state that opportunities are scored so the best work rises to the top. If scoring is a rule, this column should be P0.
- **Intent and confidence score**
Both were in the original specification and are not currently in the sheet. To be confirmed as included or dropped.

Draft for review